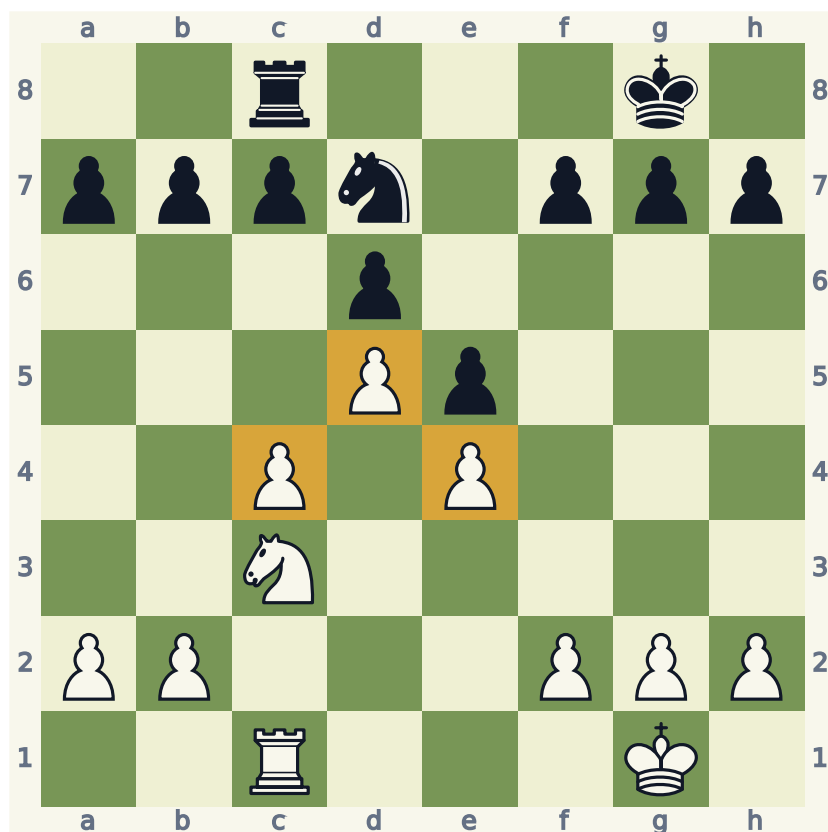


Space and restriction

Use extra room without overextending.

Space gives your pieces more useful routes and reduces the opponent's options. Its value depends on whether your pawns can be maintained. The player with less space often seeks exchanges or a freeing pawn break; the player with more space should improve coordination before adding new weaknesses.

MODEL A | WHITE TO MOVE



READ THE POSITION

- c4-d5-e4 gives White a broad central grip.
- Black's d6/e5 pawns limit the routes of Nd7.
- b4 and a4 can support queenside expansion without changing the central lock.

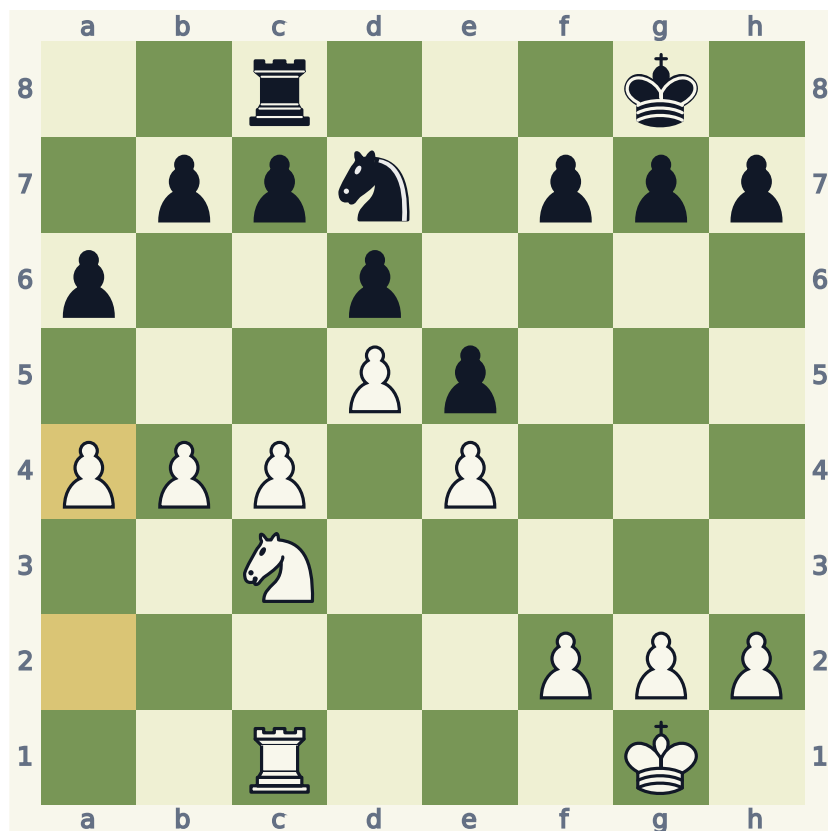
REMEMBER

- Maintain the pawn chain behind your space.
- Watch the opponent's freeing break.
- Judge exchanges by the resulting position.

Follow the logic

1. b4 a6 2. a4

MODEL A | POSITION AFTER THE LINE



b4

Gain queenside space and prepare a supported advance. The b-pawn is safe here because the c4-pawn blocks the rook's line to c3.

...a6

Black prepares to contest b5. A space advantage creates a struggle over entry squares, not free movement.

a4

White supports b5 with another pawn. Before advancing, calculate ...axb5 and watch the separate central challenge ...c6.

THE OPPONENT'S PLAN

Black can look for ...c6 to challenge d5, or ...f5 to challenge e4. Trading a pair of pieces can also reduce congestion. White should not make several flank moves without watching these breaks.

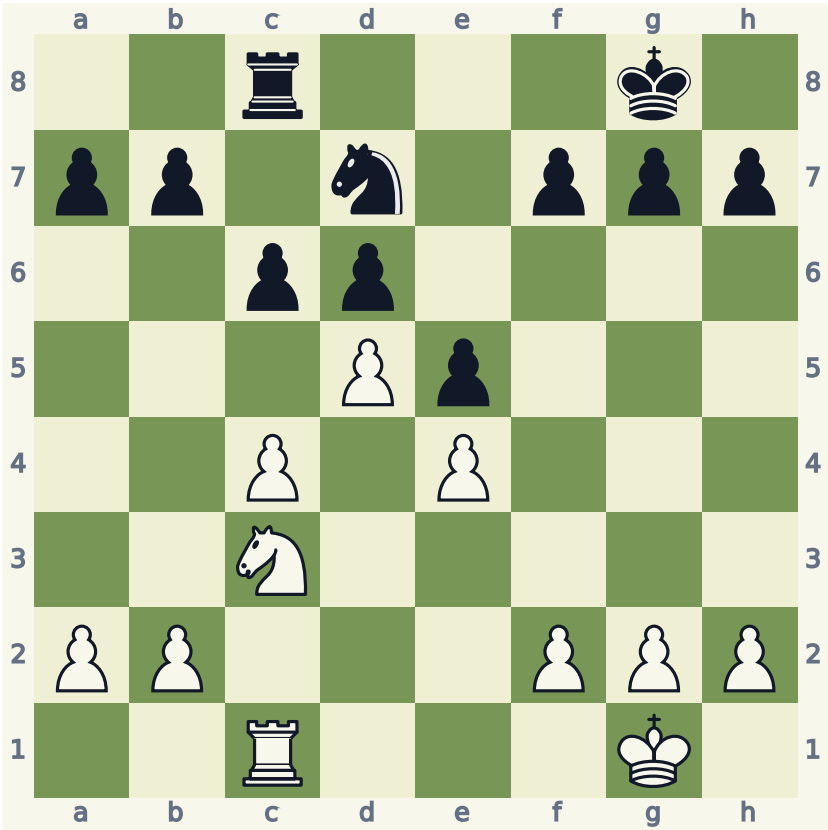
WHEN THE IDEA FAILS

Keeping pieces is a tendency, not a commandment. Exchange a dangerous enemy piece or accept a favorable endgame even when you have more space.

Find the plan

Set a timer for 6 minutes. Write the reasons, not just a move.

EXERCISE B | WHITE TO MOVE



- 1. What changed when Black's c-pawn reached c6?
- 2. What does dxc6 give up as well as gain?
- 3. After ...Rxc6, which black piece has improved?

CHANGE ONE FEATURE

Would exchanging the only black active piece necessarily help the cramped defender?

YOUR PLAN, THE OPPONENT'S REPLY, AND THE RESULTING POSITION

Position code (FEN): 2r3k1/pp1n1ppp/2pp4/3Pp3/2P1P3/2N5/PP3PPP/2R3K1 w - - 0 1

Answers and transfer

1. Black now attacks d5 directly. White can no longer treat the space advantage as a stable background feature. The center must be calculated before another queenside pawn move.
2. dxc6 removes Black's c-pawn but gives up the advanced d5-pawn and releases the central cramp. It also opens a line for the enemy rook. Exchanging tension changes who benefits from the structure.
3. The c8-rook becomes active on c6. White should compare this result with maintaining tension or supporting d5; counting only the pawns exchanged misses the main positional change.

ONE ILLUSTRATIVE LEGAL LINE

1. dxc6 Rxc6

Changed feature: No. Exchanges help a cramped side only if the resulting activity and structure improve. Removing its sole active defender can instead strengthen your grip.

APPLY IT TO YOUR GAMES

Play the exercise position for ten moves from both sides. White tries to maintain d5; Black tries to achieve an active central exchange.

Self-check: Award 0-2 points per numbered answer: 1 for the relevant fact, 1 for its consequence. Add 2 for the changed-feature answer. Revisit the lesson at 5/8 or below; repeat from memory tomorrow and one week later.

Related topics: 05, 10, 20. | Reference links and notation key: 00_Start_Here.pdf.